FREE HOBBY STARTER KIT

Stargazing Night

For the grown-up · read this first, then hand over the night card

Stargazing is the only hobby in this kit where the supply list is literally "wait until dark." No telescope, no app — the printed night card on the next page covers one whole stargazing session, from setting up an observing spot to logging what was seen before bedtime.

How to run the first night

- **Pick one predicted clear night the coming week** and pencil it in. Anticipation is half the fun.
- **Let eyes adjust for 10 minutes.** Screens off, porch light off. Saying "trust me, wait quietly" works better the fewer words you use the second time.
- **Start with the easy wins:** the Moon, the brightest star you can find, and — when visible — the Big Dipper. Each goes on the card.
- **Debrief inside with hot chocolate.** The "one thing that surprised me" line is where the best stories come from.

> **Safety notes:** stay in a familiar yard, park, or balcony. Dress warmer than you think (crouching still is cold work), and keep shoes on even in summer — dew happens. Nothing on this card requires looking anywhere near the Sun.

The no-gear rule

A blanket and the next two printed pages are the whole kit. Red flashlight? Nice to have. If a phone is used at all, put it on the dimmest screen setting and in a red-tinted mode if available — bright white light resets the night vision you just spent ten minutes earning.

Print page 2 for your one-night plan and page 3 to keep a season of nights in a binder.

Stargazing-Night Card

This card is for **one night only** — fill the top half before dark, the bottom half after you come in.

Before dark — the plan

Date:	
We start at:	
Spot:	

Tonight's sky forecast

Clear / cloudy?	
Moon: full / half / thin / none	
Blanket count:	

Tonight's treasure hunt

- ☐ The brightest star in the sky — describe its color
- ☐ The Moon (or note "no moon tonight")
- ☐ A star that twinkles colors (red, blue, white)
- ☐ A shape made of stars: your favorite gets a sketch, below
- ☐ A star moving in a straight line — or a streak that's gone in a second (a shooting star!)

My constellation sketch

Tip: don't try to draw them exactly — connect the dots you actually see, then name the shape whatever you like. "Dinosaur" is a real constellation if you say so.

After dark — three lines for the grown-up to ask about

Air felt like:	
Brightest thing I saw:	
One thing that surprised me:	

Night Log

One line per stargazing night. Three nights is already a habit.

DATE	SKY	MOON	WHAT I LOOKED FOR	WHAT I FOUND	RATING

Questions that make a night better

- Why do stars twinkle but planets don't? (Short version: our wobbling air.)
- If the sky was empty of light tonight, would you notice stars *moving* across the sky? Try again same time next month and find out.
- Count stars in one small patch of sky each night — is the count changing? That number is "sky quality."

> **Repeat bias:** the second stargazing night rarely feels as dramatic as the first. Pick a moonless night for round two, and the sky shows up changed.